Spiraea thunbergii 'Ogon'

Golden Thunberg Spirea, Mellow Yellow Spirea, Ogon Spirea

Family: Rosaceae

Rockery: 4 | Wonderland: 6 | Overlook: 3 | Fountain Garden: 24 | **TOTAL 37**



HABIT

Not available

FALL



LEAF



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant type
Tree

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous. Narrow linear-lanceolate leaves (to 1.5 in) emerge golden yellow in spring, mature to bright green in summer, turn orange/yellow/bronze in fall. Arching, willowy branches. [Missouri Botanical Garden; NC State Extension; Morris Arboretum]

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: Deciduous shrub, 3–5 ft tall and wide. Dense, twiggy, upright with outward-arching branches. Fast growth. [Missouri Botanical Garden; NC State Extension; Great Plant Picks; What Grows There]

Soil
Not stated

Sun

Water

Zone 8a
Hardy USDA Zones 4–8. Fully suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a. Early spring bloom before foliage. [Missouri Botanical Garden; NC State Extension; Chicago Botanic Garden]

Native
Not stated

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Cultivar of Spiraea thunbergii (native to China and Japan). ‘Ogon’ (Japanese for gold) discovered in Tokyo by Barry Yinger and introduced to US in 1993. Trade name Mellow Yellow. [Morris Arboretum; NC State Extension; University of Arkansas Extension]

Form
Deciduous. Narrow linear-lanceolate leaves (to 1.5 in) emerge golden yellow in spring, mature to bright green in summer, turn orange/yellow/bronze in fall. Arching, willowy branches. [Missouri Botanical Garden; NC State Extension; Morris Arboretum]

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Siting
Not stated

Soil prep
Not stated

Depth & spacing
Not stated

Best planting season
Not stated

Establishment
Plant in full sun for best color. Prune immediately after flowering to maintain shape. Low maintenance once established. Suitable for borders, foundations, massing. [Missouri Botanical Garden; NC State Extension]

HEALTH

Problem	Symptoms
Health	Rarely troubled by serious pests or diseases. Generally deer and rabbit resistant. Species may be considered invasive in some regions, but cultivar performance is standard ornamental. [What Grows There; NC State Extension; GardenersPath]